close to a local religious place called Jina Baba ki Samadhi, is a stupa site. This appears to have been made of a combination of large bricks and some stone. Incidentally, in the dam area too, which is now submerged, brick structural ruins exist and become visible, according to local people, when the water level in the dam drops. Thirty km from Junagadh, near the Ramnath forest checkpost, a large concentration of solid bricks and brickbats lies scattered. In the suburbs of Junagadh are sites marked by large bricks. One of these, near the Palasini river, is known as Hajam Chora, named after a hill where it is located. Towards the top of the hill are big blocks of dressed stones interspersed with large bricks and a number of earthen lamp (‘diya’) remains. Finally, there is Intawa, a Buddhist monastic site in the midst of a thick jungle on a hill above Bhavnath. Intawa was excavated in 1949 and yielded the foundations of monasteries, as also many artefacts ranging from water pots and coins to a rounded clay sealing which bore a legend that mentioned the seal as belonging to the Bhikshu sangha of the vihara of Maharaja Rudrasena.[20] This is likely to have been Rudrasena I (199–222 CE). Thanks to the clay sealing, this early historic site with burnt-brick architecture can be assigned a firm date.

Is there a pattern in this monumentality? The places marked by early historic bricks are dotted across a large landscape. While at Hajam Chora the brick complex is within walking distance of the remnants of the Sudarshana lake, the Ramnath Mahadev mandir site is far from the Junagadh area. In fact, it cannot be visualized in any way as forming part of the circuit that sustained the ancient provincial centre here. The distribution of the other sites in the Girnar forest area, however, begins to make sense when it is juxtaposed with the topography of the hill zone. The forested tract does not have a great deal of flat land. There are four small valleys between the Girnar range and the surrounding hills which are in the vicinity of Bhavnath, Hasnapur, Surajkund, and Bhordevi. The traditional halting places of the famous Girnar pilgrim circuit (or ‘parikrama’), which starts